

HTC Rhyme launch

The 3.7-inch HTC Rhyme has been launched in India at ₹29,990, running Android 2.3.4 on a 1 GHz Scorpion processor <http://bit.ly/vM4jfk>

Motorola Dinara XT928

Currently exclusively for China, the Dinara has a 4.5-inch HD display, 1.2GHz dual-core processor, and a 13MP camera <http://bit.ly/rrjTx1>

Apple's iPhone 4S hits store shelves in India

Apple's much-anticipated iPhone 4S hit Indian retail shelves at the end of November, approximately a month after it was unveiled in the US. The iPhone 4S has, so far, received a mixed reaction in India; mainly because of its extremely high price, as compared to other nations including the US and the UK. The device is available in three variants, 16 GB, 32 GB and 64 GB. The 16GB variant of the iPhone 4S is priced at ₹44,500, while the 32GB iPhone 4S is available for ₹50,900. The 64 GB variant of the iPhone 4S comes with a price tag of ₹57,900.

Apple's iPhone 4S runs the latest iOS 5 operating system. Apple, however, had to release an updated iOS 5.0.1 version after several iPhone 4S users abroad complained of battery life issues. The updated operating system has also brought various improvements to the platform.

The iPhone 4S has a 3.5-inch retina display, with a resolution

of 640 x 960 pixels. The 4S is equipped with an 8MP camera that records 1080p HD video. The iPhone 4S has 1 GB of RAM and is powered by ARM Cortex A9 dual core 1 GHz processor. The most talked-about feature of the iPhone 4S is personal voice recognition assistant Siri. As we



previously reported, Siri is limited outside the US and is likely to get full-functionality by 2012.

In India, the iPhone 4S is available with Airtel and Aircel. Meanwhile, the price of the iPhone 4 has been revised. The 16GB variant of the iPhone 4 is available at ₹35,500, while the 8GB iPhone 3GS is priced at ₹20,900. **d**

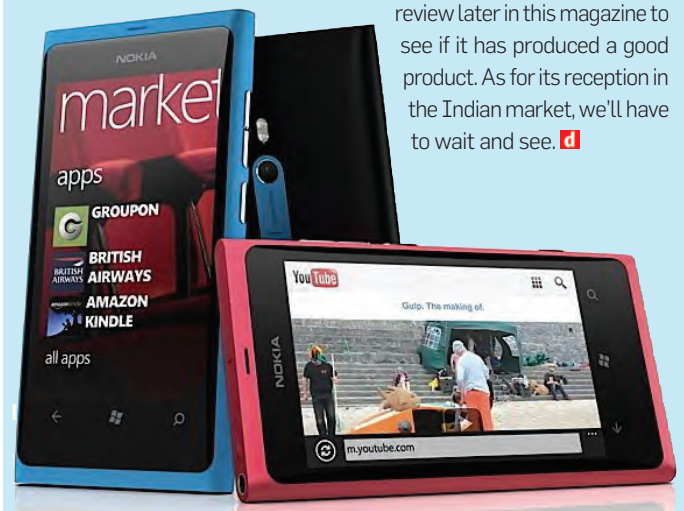
Nokia launches Lumia 800 and 710 in India, with extensive promotional campaign

Nokia has launched its initial Windows Phones, the Lumia 800 and Lumia 710 in India. Priced at ₹29,999 and ₹18,999, respectively, the devices will be available in metro cities right away, and should make it to more than 100 other cities by the end of January, according to Nokia India Director (Marketing), Viral Oza.

Nokia's Amazing Everyday campaign is one of its most extensive till date, with the Finnish mobile manufacturing truly trying out of the box approaches when it comes to advertising for the devices. This included everything from helicopter rides to music and dance concerts, and even a toll tax exemption for a couple of hours on launch day. The company has a lot invested in the launch of the first Nokia Windows Phones, with many hopes riding on the success of the Windows Phone platform.

Many experts feel the company is putting all its eggs in one basket, by limiting itself exclusively to Windows Phone. Don't miss our

review later in this magazine to see if it has produced a good product. As for its reception in the Indian market, we'll have to wait and see. **d**



Vodafone Smart launched in India for ₹4,995

Vodafone has launched its Android-based 3G phone, Vodafone Smart, in India. Priced at ₹4,995, the Vodafone Smart runs on Android 2.2.1 and is powered by the Snapdragon S1 processor. The telecom operator, which previously launched Vodafone Blue, aims to target tech-savvy users, as the phone features new mobile apps, games, internet

and social networking tools on the go. Vodafone is offering the device with a two-year warranty.

The Vodafone Smart features a 2.8-inch capacitive touch display and a 2 MP camera. For connectivity, the phone supports Wi-Fi, GPS and Bluetooth 2.1. The Vodafone Smart has just 130 MB of internal storage, though the device packs with a 2 GB memory card. The internal storage of the device

can be expanded up to 32GB via microSD card.

Vodafone is, however, not the only telecom operator to offer budget 3G mobile phones. Idea, another telecom giant in India, recently launched two Android-based budget 3G smartphones, Blade and id280. Back in August, MTS launched mTag 3.1 and MTS Livewire, budget smartphones in the sub ₹5,000 category. **d**

